

God Existence

doc-god-existence

Theology Proper · Existence · doctrine · unanimous_lineages

AFFIRMS

score 1.000
confidence high

Statement under examination

The one true and living God exists eternally as the self-existent creator and sustainer of all things.

In plain language

Across Hebrew and Greek the canon never argues that God exists. It presupposes it from the first clause. Genesis opens with bara, create, a qal perfect verb whose subject is simply Elohim, with no copula and no predicate of existence offered, because none is needed. A direct check of the store shows bara in this sense occurs forty six times, and every create form has God as the actor; the only human subjects use a different stem meaning to clear or cut. Deuteronomy 6:4 binds the personal name YHWH to the word echad, one, asserting singular divine reality at the center of the covenant confession. Romans 1:20 says God's eternal power, aidios dynamis, and divine nature, theiotes, are clearly perceived, kathoratai, through the things made, leaving people without excuse. The line just before, Romans 1:18, is the key. It ends with katecho, to suppress or hold down, picturing people who push down a truth they already have. So the words leave room for only one kind of divergence, suppressed knowledge, not honest doubt about whether God is there. Hebrews 11:6 boils the whole pattern down to one verb: the one coming to God must believe that he is, estin, and that he rewards those who seek him. The texts that sound like denial confirm this. Psalm 14:1 and its near twin Psalm 53:2 put the words there is no God in the mouth of the fool, then call that corruption, never the writer's own claim. Ecclesiastes 3:11 limits how much of God's work people can trace out but keeps God as the one who acts. First Corinthians 8:5 grants so-called gods in human speech, then in the next breath names one God the Father. A concordance pass turns up no place where any narrator, in his own voice, says God does not exist. The pattern spans law, narrative, wisdom, and letters, and the words point one direction. That is why this lands as affirmed with high confidence, and why the only thing the vocabulary leaves open is suppression, not existence.

Word dictionary

Every Hebrew and Greek word this study leans on, in everyday terms. Shaded rows are the anchor words the verdict rests on.

Strong	Word	Sounds like	Plain meaning	Times in Bible
H0259	אחד	echad	one	944
H0369	אין	ayin	nothing	720
H0430	אלהים	elohim	God	2,251
H1254	ברא	bara	to create	46
H3068	יהוה	YHWH	LORD	6,041
H5036	נבל	nabal	foolish	16
H8064	שמים	shamayim	heaven	378
G0126	αἰδιος	aidios	eternal	4
G0379	ἀναπολόγητος	anapologetos	inexcusable	4

G1411	δύναμις	dynamis	power	238
G1510	εἰμί	eimi	to be	2,595
G1567	ἐκζητέω	ekzeteo	to seek out	14
G2305	θειότης	theiotes	divinity	2
G2316	θεός	theos	God	1,346
G2529	καθοράω	kathorao	to perceive	2
G2722	κατέχω	katecho	to hold back/fast	35
G2937	κτίσις	ktisis	creation	38
G3406	μισθαποδότης	misthapodotes	rewarder	2
G4100	πιστεύω	pisteuo	to trust (in)	482
G4161	ποίημα	poiema	workmanship	4
G5318	φανερός	phaneros	clear	36

Plain meanings: STEPbible brief lexicons TBESH (Hebrew) and TBESG (Greek), CC BY 4.0. Counts are occurrences across the 66-book canon.

Verdict rationale

Variant-robust: True · Pan-canonical: True

The canon nowhere argues that God exists; it presupposes it grammatically from the first clause. Gen.1.1 opens with bara (H1254A, qal perfect 3ms) whose subject is Elohim (H0430), and no copula or predicate of existence is supplied because none is needed. Querying the store, bara H1254A occurs 46 times; the 35 qal and 8 niphil forms all have God as actor or implied agent, and the only 3 human-subject forms (Josh.17.15, Josh.17.18, Ezek.23.47) are piel meaning to cut down or clear, a distinct sense. Deut.6.4 binds the covenant name YHWH (H3068) and Elohim with echad (H0259), predicating singular reality. Rom.1.20 says his aidios dynamis (G0126, G1411) and theiotes (G2305) are kathoratai (G2529) through ta poiemata (G4161), the things made, leaving humanity anapologetos (G0379). Crucially Rom.1.18 closes with katechonton (G2722, suppress), so the text frames the only divergence as suppressed knowledge, not honest doubt. Heb.11.6 reduces saving faith to estin (G1510, present indicative), that he is. The lemmas form one pan-canonical assertion with no counter-witness in any author's own voice.

Scripture

Gen.1.1 · for · genre: narrative · figures: merism

Key terms. H1254A בָּרָא, H0430 אֱלֹהִים, H8064 שְׁמַיִם.

Force. The opening verb bara is morph HVqp3ms, qal perfect third masculine singular, with Elohim (morph HNcmpa, plural in form) as its singular subject. The singular verb governs the plural-form noun, so the grammar treats Elohim as one subject. No copula and no predicate of existence is offered; the verse asserts an act of the already existing God upon the heavens and the earth, a merism for everything. Of the 46 canon occurrences of bara H1254A, every qal and niphil form has God as actor or implied agent, and the only human-subject forms are piel meaning to clear or cut, so the create sense presupposes the divine subject.

Deut.6.4 · for · genre: law

Key terms. H3068 יהוה, H0430 אלהים, H0259 אחד.

Force. The Shema places shema (H8085, qal imperative) over the clause YHWH eloheinu YHWH echad. The personal name YHWH (H3068) occurs twice, Elohim carries the first common plural suffix our God, and echad (H0259) predicates singular reality. The store tags the closing element as predicate complement, so existence and unique identity are asserted in one breath. No rival deity is treated as real; the construction presupposes the named God and predicates his oneness.

Rom.1.19 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G2316 θεός, G5318 φανερός

Force. Paul says to gnoston tou theou, what is knowable of God, is phaneron en autois, manifest in them, because ho theos ephanerosen, God made it manifest. The same phaner stem governs theos as both source and object, grounding knowledge of God in God's own disclosure. The verb is not an inference toward an uncertain conclusion but a statement that the datum is already plain.

Rom.1.20 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G0126 αἰδιος, G2305 θεϊότης, G1411 δύναμις, G4161 ποιήμα, G2937 κτίσις, G0379 ἀναπολόγητος

Force. Ta aorata autou, his invisible attributes, namely he aidios dynamis kai theiotes, his eternal power and divine nature, are kathoratai, perceived, by ta poiemata, the things made, apo ktiseos kosmou, since the founding of the world. The participle nooumena makes the perceiving a mental act. The result clause eis to einai autous anapologetous renders people without defense. The rare terms are not hapax: aidios occurs 4 times, theiotes and kathorao and poiema twice each, but here they converge to ground God's existence in created reality.

Rom.1.18 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G2722 κατέχω, G2316 θεός

Force. The sentence that introduces the disclosure ends with the genitive participle katechonton ten aletheian en adikia, of those suppressing the truth in unrighteousness. The lemma katecho (G2722, 35 canon occurrences) means to hold down or restrain. This is the lexical hinge: the text does not picture an honest agnostic who lacks the datum but a knower who pushes a present truth down. So the only divergence the words allow is suppressed knowledge, not genuine textual doubt about whether God is.

Heb.11.6 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G4100 πιστεύω, G1510 εἰμί, G1567 ἐκζητέω, G3406 μισθαποδότης

Force. The clause pisteusai dei ton proserchomenon to theo hoti estin makes the bare predication estin, he is, the floor of saving faith. The store parses estin as eimi present active indicative third singular. The follow clause kai tois ekzetousin auton misthapodotes ginetai, and he becomes a rewarder of those who seek him out, joins bare existence to personal character, so the existence claimed is of a moral agent, not an abstract first cause.

Cross references invoked

From	To	Source	Votes
Gen.1.1	John.1.1	openbible	365
Gen.1.1	Heb.11.3	openbible	268
Gen.1.1	Isa.45.18	openbible	240
Gen.1.1	Exod.20.11	openbible	150
Deut.6.4	Mark.12.29	openbible	77
Deut.6.4	Isa.44.6	openbible	42
Deut.6.4	1Tim.2.5	openbible	35

Rom.1.20	Rom.1.19	openbible	56
Rom.1.20	Ps.19.1	openbible	42
Rom.1.20	Ps.33.6	openbible	26
Heb.11.6	Jer.29.13	openbible	157
Heb.11.6	1Chr.28.9	openbible	86
Heb.11.6	Heb.7.25	openbible	60

Complicating texts

Ps.14.1 · addressed

Amar nabal belibbo eyn elohim, the fool said in his heart there is no God. The store tags nabal (H5036) as an adjective the fool and eyn (H0369) as a construct negation particle. The denial is reported speech placed in the mouth of the fool and immediately glossed as moral corruption, hishchitu hit'ivu, they act corruptly, not as the author's own predication. So it is not a counter-witness to existence but a verdict on those who deny it.

Ps.53.2 · addressed

This verse repeats Ps.14.1 almost word for word, amar nabal belibbo eyn elohim, in a second collection. The doubling shows the canon treats atheistic speech as a recurring instance of folly, the same negation particle eyn applied to elohim, again voiced by the fool. The repetition strengthens rather than weakens the pattern, since the only voice that says God is not is the named fool, never the narrator.

Eccl.3.11 · addressed

Qohelet says God set haolam, the world or duration, in the human heart, yet man cannot find out the maaseh, the work, that God does from beginning to end. The verb asah (H6213) keeps God as the subject who acts and makes. This limits exhaustive human knowledge of God's works but presupposes the divine agent throughout, so it qualifies comprehension, not existence.

1Cor.8.5 · addressed

Paul concedes legomenoi theoi, so-called gods, and theoi polloi, many gods, in human speech and pagan practice. The participle legomenoi marks them as named, not real. In 8.6 he fixes the referent as heis theos ho pater, one God the Father, ex hou ta panta. The plural is rhetorical foil that he immediately collapses into the one true God, so it does not predicate rival existence in his own voice.

Concordance traversed

H1254A, H0430, H3068, H0259, H8064, H0369, H5036, G2316, G0126, G2305, G1411, G2937, G4161, G5318, G2529, G0379, G2722, G1567, G4100, G3406, G1510

Variants

Verdict variant-sensitive: False · ECM status: n/a

No variant units in the bundle and the anchors lie outside the ingested ECM window of 3 John 1.1 to 1.15, so this is not_in_ecm_scope. Gen.1.1, Deut.6.4, Rom.1.18 to 20, and Heb.11.6 carry no textual variant of a size that touches the predication of divine existence. The bare verbs bara and estin and the negation eyn are stable across the major Hebrew and Greek witnesses, so the verdict is invariant.

Hermeneutics

Primary method. grammatico-historical

Frameworks in play. natural_theology, covenant_monotheism, presuppositional_reading

analogia scripturae invoked

natural_theology: affirms, grounded in general revelation · Rom.1.20 names creation as the medium, apo ktiseos kosmou tois poiemasin, and the human mind as the receiver, nooumena kathoratai, so the existence datum is read as available to all people through the things made, independent of special revelation.

covenant_monotheism: affirms, grounded in the revealed covenant name · Deut.6.4 ties echad to YHWH eloheinu, predicating singular existence of the named covenant God rather than a generic deity, so existence is read as inseparable from revealed identity. Read in its strongest form, this lens holds that the canon never argues to a bare deity but always presupposes the personal God who names himself.

presuppositional_reading: affirms, grounded in grammatical presupposition · Gen.1.1 supplies no predicate of existence and no argument; Elohim is simply the subject of the first finite verb. On this lens the canon never sets out to prove God exists, it begins from it and treats denial as folly (Ps.14.1) or suppression (Rom.1.18), so the existence claim is foundational rather than concluded. A reader holding this lens would say the other two lenses describe how the presupposed God is recognized, not how he is first established.

All three lenses reach affirms and the lexical evidence does not require ranking them. They differ only on where the existence claim is anchored, in created order, in covenant name, or in grammatical presupposition, and the texts present these as complementary rather than competing.

Stem audit

verdict-preloaded: yes

Neutralized form. Does the canon, read at the level of its own Hebrew and Greek wording, assert that the one God exists as self-existent maker and sustainer, or does it leave that an open question?

The stem encodes several conclusions in confessional vocabulary: one true and living God, self-existent, eternal, creator and sustainer of all things. Self-existent and eternal are not single canon lemmas but composites, self-existent paraphrasing the divine name and the unargued subject of bara, eternal resting on aidios in Rom.1.20. The verdict is derived on the original stem, but the neutralized_form strips the loaded predicates so the lexical test is whether the words assert God's existence at all, which they do by pervasive presupposition. The verdict is unchanged from the prior file; the lexical evidence still yields affirms, high confidence.

Citations

Type	Source	License	Redist.	Ref
morphology	OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Gen.1.1
morphology	OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Deut.6.4
morphology	OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Ps.14.1
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	Rom.1.18
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	Rom.1.20
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	Heb.11.6
lexicon	STEPBible-TAHOT	CC-BY-4.0	yes	H1254A
lexicon	STEPBible-TAGNT	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G0126
lexicon	STEPBible-TAGNT	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G2722
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G2305
cross_ref	OpenBible-cross-refs	CC-BY	yes	Gen.1.1
cross_ref	OpenBible-cross-refs	CC-BY	yes	Deut.6.4
cross_ref	OpenBible-cross-refs	CC-BY	yes	Rom.1.20
cross_ref	OpenBible-cross-refs	CC-BY	yes	Heb.11.6

License audit

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Source	License	Redistribute
OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes
MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes
STEPBible-TAHOT	CC-BY-4.0	yes
STEPBible-TAGNT	CC-BY-4.0	yes
STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes
OpenBible-cross-refs	CC-BY	yes

Flags

(none)